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ForumIAS

 (Don't Write
anything in this Area)

Q.6) a) Elaborate on the "forms of religion" that were prevalent in tribal & peasant societies with appropriate examples. (20 Marks)

Durkheim In his book, "The Elementary Form of Religious Life" defined Religion as a unified system of belief and rituals related to sacred things.

→ Different Religious belief prevail among peasant and tribal societies -

① ANIMISM

→ E.B. Tylor in "Primitive Culture" defined Animism as belief in soul and spirits

→ Almost all the tribes and peasant are animistic

→ Acc. to Durkheim, Australian aborigines like Aruntas, Kooreras, Muringins etc worship their spirit life as "Shutoro"

→ Malys of Thakhand are also animistic and worship their spirit as "Gosaiyan" studied by L.P. Vidyarthi

→ Ashanti of Ghana studied worshipped their spirit "Ntoro" as studied by Evans Pritchard.

② ANIMATISM

→ This concept is given by Professor Mauss
→ Acc to him, animatism conveys belief in such power which is although beyond the census of humans but can take obode in any living or non-living thing.

→ Among Trobriand Islanders, such power is known as Mama and they believe if a warrior excell in war, he possen Mama.

→ Acc to Henry Morgan, such power is known as wakanda among Iroquois of North America

→ S.C. Dube mentioned that the peasant communities of Central India call such power

and "Pikhu" which can take abode in plough and help them with good agricultural yield.

③ FETISHISM

→ The term Fetishism is derived from a Latin term "Fetisho" which means an object considered to possess some magical power.

→ Acc to Jamun Frazer, with the help of Fetishes, a no. of magics are performed and Fetishes can be

- a skull
- a piece of bone
- Feather
- Amulet etc

→ S.C. Dutta mentioned that the peasant Kamars of MP buy a piece of bone of their ox in the agricultural field for the good yield.

④ NATURE WORSHIP

→ The concept of Naturalism was given by Max Muller

→ When human, found that natural forces are beyond their control, they began to worship them

→ Examples

- In range of Odisha worship Sun and call it as Sing Bonga
- Neuro of South Sudan worship the "Kumdos"
- Balakrishnan Tygar said that the tribes of South India worship rain god for good agricultural yield

⑤ TOTEMISM

→ This concept is given by Durkheim and in Totemism, the simpler societies associate themselves with certain plants, animals, bird and other nonliving objects + worship them.

→ Example

- Todas consider Buffalo as their Totem
- Meenas consider fish as their Totem
- Koyas of Andhra Pradesh consider crow as their tottem.

Feedback

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Structure/
Question
Content
Value
Total